

## A BLUEPRINT FOR AI-READY CAMPUSES

# Strategies from the Frontlines of Higher Education



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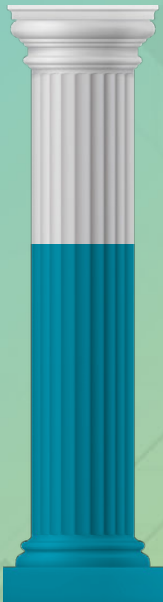
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# The Continuous Evolution of AI in Higher Education

Over the past few years, the higher education sector has witnessed a remarkable evolution in the adoption and integration of artificial intelligence (AI).

According to IDC's March 2025 *Vertical AI Use Case Survey*, 60% of higher education respondents indicated that they have already introduced several generative AI (GenAI) apps/services into production. In addition, 32% noted that their institutions have GenAI investment plans in place to be launched in the next 12 months, and the remaining 9% are in the process of early testing and proofs of concept. Not a single institution indicated that they have no plans to leverage GenAI (**Figure 1**, next page).

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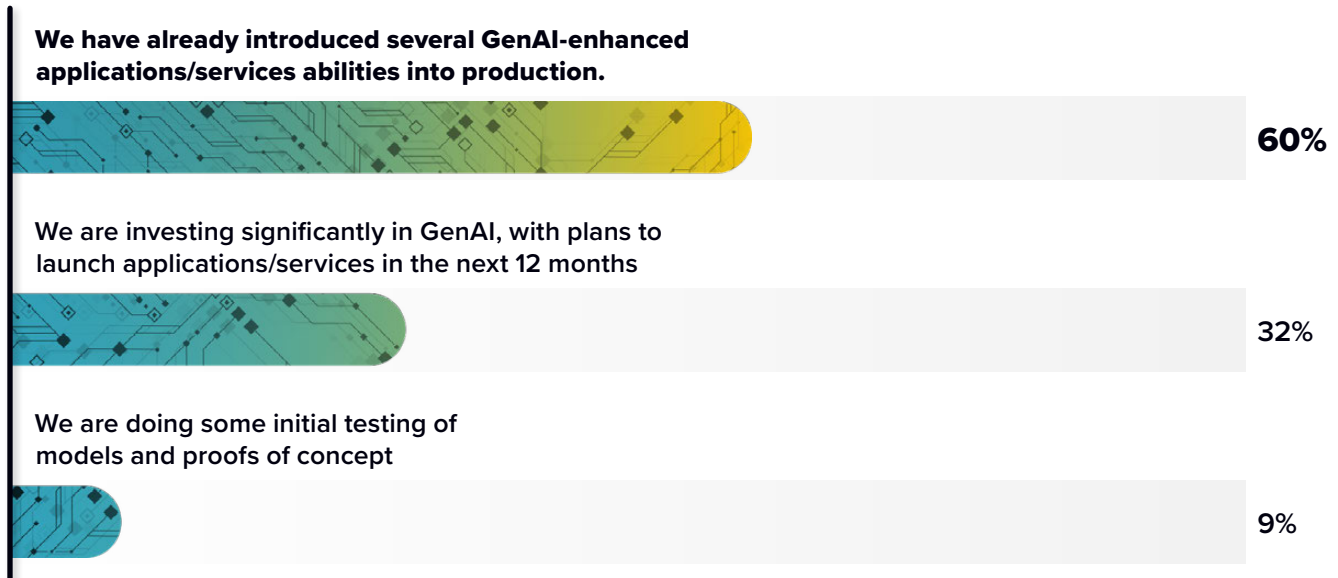
An industry known historically for moving slow with technology, institutions have flipped the narrative. The evolution of GenAI over the past several years, alongside the recent emergence of agentic AI, has further accelerated this transformation. From leveraging AI to bolstering institutional strengths and driving research innovation to fostering collaborative communities and establishing robust vendor partnerships, higher education leaders are charting a path for others to follow.

FIGURE 1

## The Current State of GenAI Adoption in Higher Education

What is your organization's current state of evaluating or using GenAI?

(Percentage of respondents)



n = 150 for higher education; Source: IDC's Vertical AI Use Case Survey, March 2025

### IDC conducted research across four forward-looking institutions:

- Auburn University
- Babson College
- Georgia Tech
- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

The industry has been on a transformative trajectory, with leading institutions aligning AI investments with long-term strategic goals, investing in AI initiatives across all major functions, developing internal AI skills and capacity, driving cultural change, and establishing AI-ready data, processes, and infrastructure. While still in the early stages of their journeys, institutions are successfully leveraging AI to enhance academic and administrative processes, improve student outcomes, and drive research innovation. As AI continues to disrupt and reshape higher education, more institutions are recognizing the need to develop clear, cohesive AI strategies to stay ahead of the curve.

In this dynamic environment, many innovative institutions are charting a path for others to follow in their adoption of AI. Informed by qualitative interviews with IT and academic leaders, this research was conducted to understand the commonalities in approaches across four forward-looking institutions in the United States: Auburn University, Babson College, Georgia Tech, and the University of North Carolina (UNC) at Chapel Hill.





# In This White Paper

This white paper provides guidance and support for other institutional leaders seeking to embark on a similar journey. By examining the best practices and strategies employed by these leaders in AI, we aim to offer valuable insights and recommendations that can help institutions navigate the complexities of AI adoption and achieve their strategic goals.

This white paper is organized into two sections:

## Section

# 1

The six common foundational characteristics of a strong AI strategy in higher education, as reflected in the practices of the institutions mentioned previously

## Section

# 2

A series of strategic, organizational, process, and technology considerations for industry leaders as they execute their AI strategies

## SECTION 1:

# Common Foundational Characteristics of Advanced AI Strategies in Higher Education

Figure 2 presents the six critical foundational characteristics of an effective AI strategy in higher education.

FIGURE 2

Common Foundational Characteristics of Advanced AI Strategies in Higher Education



## Differentiators

### Leveraging AI to Bolster Institutional Strengths

Rather than only focusing on AI-driven automation for efficiency and cost savings, institutions are identifying unique areas where AI can help differentiate and innovate, such as:

- ▶ Specialized research data sets
- ▶ Unique degree programs
- ▶ Distinctive learning experiences

By focusing on these unique strengths, institutions can enhance their competitive edge and drive significant advancements in their areas of expertise.

### CASE STUDY: UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA

**UNC is focused on leveraging its unique research data sets to drive AI innovation in academic and scientific research**

By capitalizing on its extensive and specialized data assets, UNC aims to set itself apart from peer institutions. The university's approach involves integrating AI into various research departments, enabling advanced data analysis and fostering groundbreaking discoveries. This strategic use of AI not only enhances UNC's research capabilities but also positions the institution as a leader in AI-driven research innovation. Dr. Mike Barker, UNC's vice chancellor for information technology and chief information officer (CIO), said that *"We recognize that our unique research data sets are a significant asset. Our goal is to use AI to enhance our research capabilities and make groundbreaking discoveries that highlight our strengths and differentiate us."*

“

Our goal is to use AI to enhance our research capabilities and make groundbreaking discoveries that highlight our strengths and differentiate us.”

**Mike Barker**  
Vice Chancellor for Information  
Technology and CIO, UNC



## Guardrails

### Balancing Responsible Use and Experimentation

Institutions initially focus on creating guidelines for responsible use rather than strict governance. This approach allows flexibility and innovation while ensuring ethical use, preventing institutions from preemptively restricting the campus community from leveraging AI to its full potential before they have a chance to experiment. Moving toward governance involves leveraging early learnings and experiences to shape governance models and practices that balance risk mitigation and innovation over time.

#### CASE STUDY:

#### AUBURN UNIVERSITY

##### Auburn University prioritizes guidelines and guardrails for responsible AI use for faculty, staff, and students

By emphasizing guidelines over rigid policies, Auburn ensures that ethical considerations are front and center while still fostering a culture of experimentation and innovation. As noted by Jill Albin-Hill, deputy CIO of Auburn University, *“At Auburn, we believe that responsible use of AI is crucial. Our guidelines allow for flexibility and innovation while ensuring that ethical standards are upheld, enabling our faculty and students to explore AI’s potential without undue restrictions.”*

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Our guidelines allow for flexibility and innovation while ensuring that ethical standards are upheld.”

Jill Albin-Hill  
Deputy CIO of Auburn University

## Collaborative Communities

### Fostering Collaboration, Knowledge Sharing, and a Culture of Experimentation

Creating communities or working groups where faculty, staff, and students can share best practices, collaborate on projects, and learn from each other is crucial. These collaborative environments encourage innovation and help institutions leverage collective expertise to drive AI initiatives forward.

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Our AI Generator group is a key driver of innovation, providing a platform for our community to explore new AI applications.”

**Ruben Mancha**  
Associate Professor of  
Information Systems

#### CASE STUDY: BABSON COLLEGE

**Babson College’s interdisciplinary AI lab, known as The Generator, fosters a collaborative environment where faculty, staff, and students can come together to share ideas, collaborate on AI projects, and learn from each other’s experiences**

This group has been instrumental in promoting a culture of experimentation and innovation at Babson, enabling the institution to harness the collective knowledge and creativity of its community. Ruben Mancha, associate professor of Information Systems, highlights that, *“At Babson College, our AI Generator group is a key driver of innovation, providing a platform for our community to collaborate, share best practices, and explore new AI applications.”*



## Vendor Partnerships

### Leveraging External Expertise and Capabilities

Partnering with a diverse set of technology vendors with advanced AI capabilities and offerings helps institutions access cutting-edge AI tools and expertise. These partnerships enable institutions to implement AI solutions more effectively and stay updated with the latest advancements. All institutional leaders interviewed emphasized the critical importance of AI partnerships in advancing their AI strategies. These partnerships are viewed as crucial for providing the necessary resources, expertise, and technological capabilities that institutions may not be able to develop on their own.

#### CASE STUDY: GEORGIA TECH

**Georgia Tech has been particularly proactive in establishing and leveraging AI partnerships. Leo Howell, vice president for IT and CIO at Georgia Tech, highlighted the institution's strategic approach to integrating AI across research, academics, and administration.**

Georgia Tech's AI strategy is deeply intertwined with its partnerships, particularly with major industry players such as Microsoft, OpenAI, and NVIDIA. One of the standout initiatives is the AI Makerspace, which provides students with access to over 300 GPUs in a cluster built in partnership with NVIDIA, allowing them to explore AI technologies in a safe learning environment.



**Georgia Tech partners with major industry players such as Microsoft, OpenAI, and NVIDIA.**

# Change Management and Training

## Continuously Upskilling at All Levels

Providing comprehensive, ongoing training programs to ensure that all stakeholders, at all levels of the institution, are comfortable and proficient with AI tools is essential. This includes investing in dedicated change management programming and leadership roles that focus on not only training and upskilling but also leveraging change management frameworks to drive the culture transformation required for successful AI adoption.

In addition, reimagining the role of humans and anticipating job changes are crucial. Using AI to elevate human work to focus on more strategic, collaborative, and creative tasks while increasing productive output involves exploring AI tools to understand the opportunities this technology presents and then redefining faculty and staff roles and responsibilities accordingly. This helps people understand how they can master AI skills to become indispensable, supporting them along the way. In addition, providing centralized resources and support ensures that faculty, staff, and students have the tools they need to adopt and effectively use AI.

### CASE STUDY: AUBURN UNIVERSITY

#### **Auburn University has been proactive in providing comprehensive training and support for AI adoption**

The university's Teaching with AI course helps faculty integrate AI into their curriculum, ensuring that they are comfortable and proficient with AI tools. This course is part of a broader initiative to upskill faculty, staff, and students, preparing them for the future of work. Auburn's approach includes not only formal training programs but also ongoing support and resources to help stakeholders continuously improve their AI skills. As noted by Dr. Asim Ali, executive director of the Biggio Center for the Enhancement of Teaching and Learning at Auburn University, *"Our goal is to provide the best environment on campus for students, professional staff, and faculty to learn about different resources, tools, and ideas and to critically think about their impact on society."*

## Leadership

### Balancing Top-Down Leadership and Bottom-Up Growth While Driving Culture Change

Effective AI leadership requires both top-down buy-in and investment from institutional leaders, as well as bottom-up, grassroots innovation to build a culture of AI innovation. Leadership at the top ensures that faculty, staff, and students feel encouraged to use the technology and that AI initiatives are prioritized and adequately resourced. Meanwhile, grassroots efforts foster creativity from faculty, staff, and students. This balanced approach helps create a supportive environment for AI adoption and ensures that AI initiatives align with the institution's strategic goals.

#### CASE STUDY: UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA

**UNC exemplifies a balanced approach to AI leadership. The institution's leadership is highly supportive of AI initiatives, providing the necessary resources and strategic direction while encouraging grassroots innovation through collaborative efforts.**

Christopher Clemens, provost and chief academic officer, emphasized the importance of creating an environment where faculty, staff, and students are the drivers of AI innovation: *"We want to set the example of what we want AI to do for our institution and give them the tools, skills, and encouragement they need to bring that vision to life,"* he said.

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**We want to set the example of what we want AI to do for our institution.”**

**Christopher Clemens**  
Provost and Chief Academic Officer,  
University of North Carolina





## SECTION 2:

# Recommendations for IT and Academic Leaders

This section outlines critical strategic, organizational, process, and technological recommendations when shaping and advancing AI strategies in higher education

## Strategic Recommendations

### Align AI Investments with the Institution's Broader Strategic Vision

- ✓ Ensure AI investments are aligned with the institution's broader strategic vision
- ✓ Identify areas where AI can significantly contribute to achieving long-term goals and objectives, maximizing the impact of AI initiatives and supporting the overall mission and vision of the organization

Every leader interviewed for this study indicated that AI investments are part of a broader institutional transformation effort tied to goals such as promoting student success, accelerating research innovation, or streamlining administrative processes. Patty Patria, CIO of Babson College, discussed how she works to align the college's AI investments with the strategic visions across the areas of teaching and learning, research, student success, and operations. She said, *"We have intense interest and demand coming from all areas of the institution. So, we take care to work very closely with everyone to gather feedback, understand what their needs are, and build tools and solutions for them. AI is a strategic capability in our broader toolset to achieve our larger goals."*

## Invest in “AI for All”

- ✓ **Democratize access to diverse AI tools by ensuring all students, faculty, and staff, regardless of their background or area of focus, have access to AI resources**  
**This approach promotes equity and fosters a culture of innovation across the institution**

Babson College provides generative AI tools to all students, staff, and faculty and has an AI grant process available to the community for the more advanced use of AI agents and bots to allow for additional innovation, while Auburn University ensures access to AI resources for all faculty, students, and staff. Howell also emphasizes the importance of diversifying access to different tools for all users across the entire campus community: *“Our goal is to expose people to as many tools as possible, creating an AI for all strategies that ensures everyone at Georgia Tech can leverage AI to enhance their work and learning experiences.”*

Adopting a persona-based approach, institutions such as Georgia Tech implemented AI across various domains, including student success, teaching, research, and administration, tailoring AI solutions to accelerate work and enhance the experiences of users in those domains. Albin-Hill believes it is important to understand the daily lives and work of faculty and staff in order to provide them with AI tools that improve outcomes in their work. Discussing the role of academic advisors, she said, *“We need to be more empathetic, and we need to know the day in the life of an advisor. We will do better work, and we’ll provide better tools and a better ecosystem if we understand what’s on the other end of what they do.”*

## Create a Flexible and Adaptive Strategy

- ✓ **Institutions should adopt an iterative approach to AI implementation, allowing for quick pivots and adjustments based on what works and what doesn’t**

Prioritizing progress over perfection is crucial, as the AI landscape evolves rapidly. Babson College exemplifies this by pivoting quickly from initial AI pilots that didn’t work and encouraging the campus community to fail fast and adapt. Auburn University also adopts an iterative approach to AI adoption in education and research, focusing on building maturity and making progress over time to stay ahead of the curve.

## Maintain a Long-Term Perspective

- ✓ **While it’s important to be flexible and adaptive, having a long-term strategic vision for AI helps guide decision-making and ensures that AI initiatives align with broader institutional goals**

UNC focuses on long-term strategic planning over short-term investments and chasing shiny objects. In an interview, Barker stated, *“We need to take a longer view of building capabilities and strengthening our unique data sets that enable us to use AI effectively and strategically.”*

## Measure Impact and Success

- ✓ **Establishing clear metrics to measure the impact of AI initiatives helps institutions understand their effectiveness and make data-driven decisions**

Babson College’s AI dashboard tracks interactions, project statuses, and training completions. Auburn University uses surveys and engagement metrics to assess the impact of its AI initiatives. Tracking these metrics ensures that AI projects are aligned with institutional goals and deliver the desired outcomes.

## Allocate Adequate Resources for AI Initiatives

- ✓ **Institutions must ensure that AI initiatives are supported with adequate financial and technical resources** This includes allocating sufficient budget for AI projects, investing in necessary infrastructure, and providing ongoing support to maintain and scale AI solutions

Under-resourcing AI investments can lead to suboptimal outcomes and hinder the potential benefits of AI. Babson College invests in infrastructure and technical support to back its AI projects, ensuring it has the necessary resources to achieve its goals. According to Patria, *“Things are changing so quickly with AI that it is hard to plan ahead. We do our best to anticipate where AI is going and define how we want to leverage it so that we can strategically allocate resources. You need to have a strategy so that you can align resources toward your goals.”*

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Patty Patria  
CIO, Babson College



# Organizational Recommendations

## Define Clear Decision-Making Roles and Responsibilities

- ✓ Establishing clear decision-making roles and responsibilities is crucial for the successful implementation of AI projects. Institutions should define who is responsible for various aspects of AI strategy, including governance, implementation, and oversight.

This clarity ensures accountability, streamlines decision-making processes, and helps coordinate efforts across different departments. UNC clearly defines roles within its AI committee, ensuring that responsibilities for governance, implementation, and oversight are well-established. Auburn University assigns specific roles to faculty and staff involved in AI initiatives, ensuring clear accountability and effective coordination.

## Prioritize Strong, Clear Communication

- ✓ Effective communication from leadership is crucial to ensure that everyone within the institution understands the AI goals and vision. Clear, consistent messaging helps align efforts across departments and fosters a shared understanding of the strategic direction.

UNC's leadership regularly communicates the strategic vision for AI, ensuring that faculty, staff, and students are aware of the goals and expected outcomes. Auburn University uses virtual town hall meetings and regular updates to keep everyone informed about AI initiatives and progress.

## Foster Inclusive Decision-Making and Stakeholder Engagement

- ✓ Encouraging collaboration across departments and engaging all stakeholders, including those who may be skeptical of AI, ensure that diverse perspectives are considered in the strategic vision and decision-making process.

Babson College promotes cross-departmental collaboration through working groups and committees, ensuring that all voices are heard. As Mancha said, *"Making sure that everyone is represented and included and everyone has a voice in the early stages of investing in technology is important, not just in terms of dollars but also ensuring that they have a voice in what they would like to explore and how it should be implemented."*

“

We want to provide an environment that encourages faculty, staff, and students to experiment with AI, learn from their experiences, and not be afraid to fail.”

Dr. Asim Ali  
Executive Director, Biggio Center for the Enhancement of Teaching  
Auburn University

## Build Internal Capacity

- ✓ Institutions should focus on reskilling existing staff and hiring new talent with AI expertise to ensure they have the internal capabilities to support AI initiatives

Babson College created a senior director of analytics and AI role to oversee its AI initiatives; faculty on Babson’s Generator team also provide robust training to other faculty to help embed AI in the curriculum. As part of these efforts, Babson leverages faculty, staff, and students with advanced AI skills to serve as coaches and trainers for others across the campus community, helping scale AI training and skill development more effectively than traditional training methods.

In addition, every institution involved in this research invests in training faculty, staff, and students on how to use AI effectively in their work, teaching, and research. Georgia Tech, meanwhile, is deeply focused on bringing students from across disciplines to its AI Makerspace to build AI skills and enhance learning outcomes while preparing them for the future of work.

## Encourage Faculty, Staff, and Students to Innovate and Fail Fast

- ✓ Institutions should foster a culture of innovation and continuous improvement by encouraging experimentation and allowing for quick pivots when something doesn’t work

Babson College emphasizes the importance of not being afraid to fail and pivot quickly when necessary. Auburn University’s AI@AU initiative encourages faculty to experiment with new AI applications. “We want to provide an environment that encourages faculty, staff, and students to experiment with AI, learn from their experiences, and not be afraid to fail,” said Ali. “This approach fosters innovation and helps us continuously improve our AI initiatives.”

## Allow Time and Space for AI Adoption

- ✓ Given the varying degrees of AI literacy, skills, trust, and comfortability with the technology, it is essential to allow faculty, staff, and students to adopt AI at their own pace
- ✓ Adoption should not be forced, especially in an academic setting where the focus is on learning and innovation
- ✓ Providing time and space for individuals to explore and become comfortable with AI ensures a more organic and effective integration of the technology

Babson College emphasizes the importance of providing training and support while allowing individuals to adopt AI tools at their own pace. Auburn University offers flexible training programs and resources, encouraging faculty and students to explore AI applications without pressure. As Pascal Van Hentenryck, A. Russell Chandler III chair and professor at Georgia Tech, notes, *“We need to balance the urgency of adopting AI with the need to provide a supportive environment where everyone can learn and experiment at their own pace. This approach ensures that we harness the full potential of AI while fostering a culture of continuous learning and innovation.”*

## Acknowledge and Address Community Concerns

- ✓ Institutions must recognize and address the concerns of the campus community regarding the adoption of AI. Themes such as faculty resistance, fears of displacement, and broader cultural inertia are significant challenges that must be acknowledged

By openly discussing these concerns, institutions can foster a more inclusive and supportive environment.

- ✓ Implementing low-stakes experimentation and promoting community-led innovation are effective strategies to mitigate these fears

These approaches enable faculty and staff to engage with AI technology in a controlled and supportive environment, thereby reducing anxiety and fostering confidence.

- ✓ Encouraging open dialogue and providing clear communication about the benefits and limitations of AI can help alleviate resistance and create a culture of trust and collaboration

By addressing these challenges head-on, institutions can ensure a smoother transition and greater acceptance of AI initiatives.



# Process and Technology Recommendations

## Build AI-Ready Infrastructure

- ✓ Investing in robust AI infrastructure is crucial to support the institution's broader AI ambitions. This includes providing the necessary hardware, software, and technical resources to enable AI applications across various domains, from classrooms to research labs and administrative offices.

Georgia Tech invests in AI infrastructure, such as the AI Makerspace and high-performance computing resources, to support research, teaching, and administrative applications. Auburn University focuses on building robust AI infrastructure, including datacenters and cloud partnerships, to support its AI initiatives across the institution. However, it is important to recognize that institutions don't need robust AI infrastructure to get started, as they can partner with AI vendors to leverage cloud computing and AI resources for pilots while building out their own GPU and CPU clusters.

## Ensure AI-Ready Data

- ✓ Establishing a robust data management strategy is essential for effective AI implementation. This includes focusing on data governance, cleaning, and integration to create reliable data sets for AI applications.
- ✓ Investing in dedicated data engineering teams ensures data quality and creates strong data pipelines that feed AI systems.

UNC invests in data management practices to ensure that research data sets are clean, coherent, and ready for AI applications. Auburn University implements robust data governance policies to maintain high-quality data for AI initiatives. Georgia Tech emphasizes the importance of building data engineering teams to support its AI initiatives. As Howell said in an interview, *"Building strong data engineering teams is crucial for ensuring that our AI models are trained on high-quality, reliable data. This foundation allows us to leverage AI effectively and ensures AI is accurate and trustworthy."*

## Build AI-Ready Processes

- ✓ Conducting necessary business process transformation work is crucial to enable AI-driven automation.
- ✓ Institutions need to evaluate and redesign processes to ensure they are optimized for AI integration, which can lead to increased efficiency and effectiveness.

Babson College focuses on problem areas where it can integrate AI solutions seamlessly for operational improvements. Auburn University focuses on process elimination, then optimization to support AI-driven automation in various operational areas. *“It’s not just about upskilling or automating but about inspiring this process of thinking about the work of faculty, staff, and students and how that work is changing with AI,” said Albin-Hill. “We need to understand how AI can and will change our processes and adapt what humans do accordingly.”*

## Prioritize Privacy and Security

- ✓ **Institutions must prioritize privacy and security as core principles in their AI strategy** This involves implementing robust data protection measures, ensuring compliance with relevant regulations, and designing AI systems that safeguard sensitive information from the outset
- ✓ **By embedding privacy and security into the design and development of AI solutions, institutions can build trust and protect the integrity of their data**

UNC focuses on privacy and security by design, ensuring that AI initiatives comply with data protection regulations and safeguard sensitive information from the start. Similarly, Auburn University implements comprehensive security protocols and privacy measures to protect data used in AI applications, as doing so is a core component of the institution’s overall strategy.



# Looking Ahead

The journey of integrating AI into higher education is both transformative and complex. As illustrated by the experiences of Auburn University, Babson College, Georgia Tech, and the UNC Chapel Hill, successful AI adoption requires a strategic approach that balances innovation with thoughtful implementation.

Institutions must leverage their unique strengths, foster collaborative communities, and establish robust partnerships to navigate the evolving AI landscape. By prioritizing comprehensive training, clear leadership, and adaptive strategies, higher education leaders can ensure that AI initiatives are inclusive, effective, and aligned with long-term goals. As AI continues to advance, it is imperative for institutions to remain flexible, invest in necessary resources, and uphold ethical standards.

Importantly, succeeding in the age of AI is not just about technology; it is about equipping faculty, staff, and students with the tools, skills, and resources to use the technology to advance their work. Therefore, an emphasis on human-AI collaboration — elevating the role of humans so that people and technology are working together and leveraging their respective strengths to achieve greater outcomes — must be the leading priority for institutional leaders. This effort will involve understanding and critically evaluating the changes and opportunities offered for faculty, staff, and researchers to focus on higher-value tasks and responsibilities as AI radically transforms their work.

Through thoughtful and strategic AI integration, higher education can set new benchmarks for excellence, driving innovation and improving outcomes for students, faculty, and the broader academic community, creating a better, more prosperous future for the industry.

## An Overview of AI Initiatives at Auburn University, Babson College, Georgia Tech, and UNC Chapel Hill

### Auburn University

**Auburn University's AI@AU initiative is aimed at establishing a comprehensive, universitywide computational infrastructure dedicated to AI-enabled research and education**

A key differentiator of this initiative is its focus on AI for teaching and learning, spearheaded by the Biggio Center for the Enhancement of Teaching and Learning. The Biggio Center has developed programs such as the internationally recognized "Teaching with AI" course, which helps faculty integrate AI into their curriculum at all levels of education, with the goal of enhancing both teaching practices and student learning outcomes. By fostering cross-disciplinary collaborations and providing robust training and support, Auburn University aims to position itself as a leader in AI-driven educational innovation.

### Babson College

**Babson College's AI initiatives are a collaborative effort between information technology staff and faculty on "The Generator," an interdisciplinary AI lab that reimagines the future of tech entrepreneurship**

The Generator focuses on infusing AI into the curriculum in several key areas, including AI for business innovation, AI ethics and society, and AI for experiential learning. A notable aspect of Babson's approach is its emphasis on entrepreneurial AI, leveraging the college's strengths in entrepreneurship education. The Generator also leads the AI Teaching Training Program, which has peer trained over 50% of Babson's faculty in AI concepts and tools, driving organic and collaborative AI adoption across the campus community.



## Georgia Tech

Georgia Tech's AI Makerspace is a dedicated supercomputer hub designed to provide students across disciplines with hands-on experience in AI. This initiative, launched in collaboration with NVIDIA and Penguin Computing, democratizes access to advanced computing resources typically reserved for researchers or tech companies.

The AI Makerspace supports AI education by integrating practical AI tools into coursework and offering resources such as workshops, certifications, and teaching kits. By focusing on interdisciplinary applications and workforce development, Georgia Tech aims to prepare students to tackle real-world AI challenges and lead in the rapidly evolving field of AI.

## UNC Chapel Hill

UNC Chapel Hill is leveraging AI to drive research innovation across various disciplines. The university's approach involves integrating AI into academic and scientific research, utilizing its extensive and specialized data assets.

The College of Arts and Sciences' computer science department and the School of Data Science and Society are at the forefront of these efforts, working collaboratively on a range of issues. By focusing on AI-driven data analysis and fostering interdisciplinary collaborations, UNC aims to enhance its research capabilities and make groundbreaking discoveries.

